

D. R. SHACKLETON BAILEY, *Statius. Silvae*, Cambridge (Mass.) - London: Harvard University Press, 2003, 438 pp., ISBN 0-674-99604-6.

This edition, with an introduction, English translation, and notes, replaces the previous edition of Statius by J. H. Mozley (first published in 1928, with numerous reprints) in the prestigious Loeb collection, which is widely diffused in the Anglophone academic world. Mozley's edition of the complete Statius filled two volumes. By contrast, Shackleton Bailey's edition occupies three: the volume under review (I) contains the *Silvae*; volume II contains *Thebaid*, Books 1-7; and volume III contains *Thebaid*, Books 8-12, and *Achilleid*. The editor, Shackleton Bailey (Sh. B.), Emeritus Professor at Harvard University and renowned textual critic (editor, for example, of Cicero, Horace, and Martial as well), never once mentions his predecessor in either notes or bibliography, so that we can discover neither what his estimation of the previous edition is, nor how his own edition will be different. On the book's dust-jacket, however, the publisher inserts the following comment: "Bailey's new edition of the *Silvae*, a freshly edited Latin text and graceful translation, replaces the earlier Loeb Classical Library edition with translation by J. H. Mozley". From this note it may be inferred that the differentiation claimed is twofold, affecting the Latin text as well as the English translation. Indeed, Mozley's edition now seems excessively old, at least with regard to the style of the English translation, which is very archaizing.

The work consists of a very brief introduction to Statius and the *Silvae*, written by Sh. B. himself (pp. 3-10); a sort of annex to the introduction, the work of Kathleen M. Coleman (also Professor at Harvard), with the title "Recent scholarship on the *Silvae* and their context: an overview" (pp. 11-21); a list of abbreviations (p. 22); the text with English translation and notes (pp. 23-381); a "Critical

Appendix" (pp. 383-404); and an Index of names (pp. 405-38).

On the title page of the edition (p. 1) the Latin title, *Silvae*, is accompanied by a dubious English translation: "Extempore Poems". Sh. B. briefly mentions the issue in the Introduction (p. 5), and concludes in a highly summary judgment that the title *Silvae* refers to "impromptu... compositions", discarding the possibility that the title might also include the notion of variety (something indicated by numerous authors, whom Sh. B. neither mentions nor refutes).

The introduction (pp. 3-10), entirely too brief to be useful, deals with the following points: the career of Statius, the dating and title of the *Silvae*, the history of the text, a review of the commentaries published on the *Silvae*, and notes on the English translation. In the majority of these matters Sh. B. simply presents a summary of what the *doctrina communis* is, without contributing anything new of substance. On the question of the titles of the individual poems, Sh. B. uncritically accepts the opinion of K. M. Coleman, that they are not Statius' own. But there are a sufficient number of critics who maintain that Statius is indeed the author of these titles and, at the very least, some argumentation on this point is necessary. In the review section on the commentaries on the *Silvae*, Sh. B. rightly describes as still useful the older commentary of Vollmer on all the *Silvae* (1898), to which he adds the commentaries to Books II and IV of H. J. Van Dam (1984) and K. M. Coleman (1988), respectively. He is unaware of the commentary on Book III of the *Silvae* by the author of this review (G. Laguna Mariscal, *Estacio. Silvas III*, Madrid - Sevilla 1992), and a number of older commentaries on individual poems: C. A. H. P. Herzog, *Stati Epithalamion* (*Silu. I, 2*), diss. Leipzig 1881; A. Imhof, *Stati ecloga ad uxorem* (*III 5*), diss. Halle, 1863; and O. Lottich, *Statius' Trostgedichte an den Claudius Etruscus* (*silv. III 3*), diss. Hamburg, 1893. Particularly unfair, however, is the total omission of the edition of the *Silvae*, with French translation and very complete notes (the one most resembling a commentary since Vollmer), by H. Frère and H. J. Izaac, *Stace. Silves*, Paris: Les Belles Lettres, 1944, 1961². Likewise, running commentaries on individual poems or

small groups of *Silvae* have been published recently, which are equally unknown to Sh. B.: A. Krüger, *Die lyrische Kunst des Publius Papinius Statius in Silvae II 2. Villa Surrentina Pollii Felicis*, Frankfurt am Main 1998 (see the review by B. Gibson, *CR* 53, 2003, 105–6); and O. Pederzani, *Il talamo, l'albero e lo specchio. Saggio di commento a Stazio Silvae I 2, II 3, III 4*, Bari 2000.

The editor does not appear to be as familiar with the very extensive secondary bibliography that has been published on the *Silvae* as might be expected, given that, surprisingly, it is Professor Kathleen M. Coleman who, in the excursus “Recent scholarship on the *Silvae* and their context: an overview” (pp. 11–21), takes on the task of reviewing and commenting on the bibliography which has appeared in modern times, from 1965 (the publication date of H. Cancik, *Untersuchungen zur lyrischen Kunst des P. Papinius Statius*, Hildesheim, a monograph which represents the beginning of modern research on the *Silvae*) to 2002 (the year of the appearance of two very important monographs: C. E. Newlands, *Statius’ Silvae and the Poetics of Empire*, Cambridge; and R. R. Nauta, *Poetry for Patrons. Literary Communication in the Age of Domitian*, Leiden, Boston, and Cologne). Coleman’s survey touches on the following aspects: the cultural environment of Statius and his *Silvae*, relations with the emperor and patrons, the question of adulation, and the improvised character of these compositions. Although Coleman’s chapter is informative and useful in itself, its insertion in this book brings to the reader’s mind the Horatian phrase *humano capiti cervicem... equinam / iungere*, in that it makes additionally evident the editor’s seeming unawareness of the bibliography reviewed by her. The monographs listed above (as well as the previously mentioned commentaries, unknown to Sh. B.) would have been helpful to the editor in order to improve the understanding of a number of passages, avoid certain errors which I will discuss below, and, finally, enrich the exegetical notes (more on these notes below).

Be that as it may, the English translation is an undeniable achievement of this edition. This is a translation which aspires

to be modern, fluid, and idiomatic, surpassing the “King James Version” style of Mozley’s older translation. Any passage will sufficiently prove this difference in style and tone, a difference that makes the translation all that much more readable for the wider public: 1.2.1-3 *Quod tibi praerepti, Melior, solamen alumni / improbus ante rogos et adhuc vivente favilla / ordiar?* “How can I begin to console thee, Melior, for thy foster-son untimely taken? How can I heartlessly sing before the pyre, while the ashes are still aglow?” (Mozley’s translation); “How shall I begin, Melior, to console you for the foster child that Fate has snatched away from you, as I stand before the pyre and the embers still glow- ‘tis presumption?” (Sh. B.’s translation). However, I note here some specific errors of interpretation of the Latin text, or rather my suggestions to improve the accuracy of the translation. Some of these errors (especially the *lacunae* in the translation) suggest that copy-editing in this volume has been poor (a shortcoming specially regrettable in any edition)¹: 1.2.30 *viderunt* is translated literally as “have seen”, but I believe that it should be interpreted as the perfect of suspension of action (“they have ceased to see”, “they see no more”); 1.2.72 *Nobilitas gavisa tulit* is translated literally as “Nobility produced him rejoicing”, but in the Latin expression there is a syntactic Graecism, undetected by Sh. B. (or by Mozley), which should be translated as “Nobility rejoiced in producing him / was glad to produce him”; 1.2.167-68 *non ideo tibi tale decus... / meque dedi*, “I did not give you such grace,... and my own self”, is obscure: what does “I did not give you my own self” mean?; *meque dedi*, with Venus speaking and in the mannerist style of Statius, is equivalent to *meam venustatem dedi*, and should be translated by something like “I did not give you such grace,... and my own charm / grace /

¹I list here a few of the misprints I have detected: p. 22: the date of L. Håkanson’s book, Statius’ *Silvae*, is not 1974, but 1969; p. 25: “villa or the Anio” for “villa on the Anio”; 1 Praef. Tit. SUO SALVTEM; 1.4.36 tenviore; 1.6.15 Ebosea (in the apparatus: Ebosia Vollmer); 2.6.103 alius... Phileton must be a misprint for alium... Phileton (translated as “another Philetos”); 3.4.tit. FLAVI EARINI suffers from a faulty typographic impression; p. 402 Tarrpei for Tarpei; p. 387: “Iviza” for “Ibiza”.

beauty" (Mozley: "and my own spirit"); 1.2.252 *ipse... Philitas*, "Philetas" (*ipse* has not been translated); 1.4.39-40 *quae tum patrumque equitumque notavi / lumina et ignarae plebis lugere potentes* is blatantly misunderstood: "What luminaries of Senate and Knights did I then note, and the common folk not wont to mourn the powerful!". However, *lumina* refers simply to the eyes (as the seat of weeping) of the three Roman social classes (senators, knights, and plebeians). In order to explain his translation, Sh. B. writes a strange note on *plebis*: "Grammatically with *lumina*, 'of the common folk'. But for *lumina* another noun, as 'crowds', is mentally substituted by zeugma, a figure much favoured by Statius." (n. 7 on p. 74). Unfortunately, Sh. B. has not read A. E. Housman's note on this passage, in his critique of Vollmer's commentary: "These words describe the public grief at the illness of Rutilius Gallicus; they are quite easy, and they mean 'quales (quam maestos) notavi oculos patrum equitumque atque adeo plebis, quae potentes lugere non consuevit'" (A. E. Housman, *Marcus Manilius. Astronomica*, London 1903-1916 [rep. Hildesheim 1972], li). Mozley, incidentally, translated the passage correctly; at 1.4.48 Sh. B. completely omits the translation of the phrase *et ferrum mulcere toga*; at 2.5.27, *magni* is not translated; at 2.7.103, *alius* is not translated; at 3. *Praef.* 27, *vale* is not translated; at 3.1.151, *ridetque* plus accusative is not likely to mean "smiles at", but rather "makes fun of" (*OLD s.u. rideo* 1c and d); at 3.5.62, *plenis* seems to have the implicit meaning of "fertile" (as an echo of Verg. *Aen.* 7.53 *plenis... annis*; cf. my own *Estacio. Silvas III*, 374), a sense which is not picked up in the translation.

Each book of the *Silvae* is preceded by some brief "Prefatory notes", where some information on the dating and prosopography of the poems is supplied. These notes are clearly insufficient, for they scarcely touch on literary questions, such as the generic ascription of each poem, principal models, and other pertinent literary traits. For example, only 3.2 is it mentioned as being a "send-off" poem, but a sample from the extensive bibliography available on this genre, called προπεμπτικόν, should have been provided (cf. my *Estacio. Silvas III*, 191). The footnotes are rather scanty and over-succinct, despite the editor's somewhat

immodest claim that they contain “*much* hermeneutic and/or revelatory matter, such as may concern any commentator to come” (p. 10; emphasis mine). In a few instances, these notes contain notable errors or inconsistencies with the proposed text and/or with the translation. For example, note 15 on p. 35 *ad* 1.1.46 says: “*Equestris* is adjective from *eques*, not *equus*; not therefore “equine”. But the accepted text is *habitus... eriles* (*equestres* is relegated to the *apparatus*), and the English translation is “his master’s mien”; 2.2.34–35 *si subeas Ephyres Baccheidos altum / culmen, ab Inoo fert semita tecta Lechaeo*: the editor adequately defends *Lechaeo* (*Lechaeum* being the harbor of Corinth), but he reproduces a difficulty relative to the portico alluded to by Statius, a difficulty which was already adduced by van Dam in his commentary: “but the walls were not covered, nor did they run up to Akrokorinth” (p. 125, n. 11). Now then, Sh. B. would have benefited from a reading of R. Mayer’s review of van Dam’s commentary on Book II, in *CR* 36, 1986, 51: “Van Dam says this must be Acrocorinth, but that we know of no portico leading to it. Consultation of a work on ancient architecture or even of the old *Encyclopedia Britannica* (art. ‘Corinth’) would reveal that there was a straight paved road that led from the market place past the eminence on which stands Apollo’s temple (the *altum culmen* perhaps) down to *Lecheum*; it had a portico on each side”; in 5.3.141–5 Statius mentions his father’s victories in the poetry competitions in the Pythian, Nemean, and Isthmian Games. Sh. B. states in footnote 32 (p. 359) that there is “no mention of Olympia”. But there cannot be such a mention, for the simple reason that the Olympic Games, unlike the other three Greek festival mentioned, did not include a poetry contest.

Of course, Sh. B.’s most important and ambitious contribution in this edition is the establishment of a Latin text. But here one should not speak of a critical edition *sensu stricto*. Rather, it is a revised text, given that the editor has not consulted a single manuscript. As is well known, the text of Statius’ *Silvae* depends upon a single witness, the manuscript *M* (*Matritensis* 3678), copied around 1417. This manuscript has a high degree of textual corruption, and all other extant manuscripts, known as *Itali*, derive from it. Sh. B. has not considered it necessary to

consult either *M*, or any of the *Itali*. He himself acknowledges (p. 9) that all of his textual information (on the readings of *M*, the *Itali*, and conjectures by scholars) depends upon Courtney's Oxford Text (1990). Because the editor bases his documentation exclusively on Courtney's edition, occasional errors occur: thus *expertura* appears in the text at 1.3.51 without any note whatsoever in the *apparatus*, as was the case in Courtney's edition (this misprint was corrected in the reprint of the Oxford edition); in fact, *est experta* is *M*'s reading, *expertura* being a conjecture by Phillimore (see my review of Courtney's edition in *Gnomon* 66, 1994, 15 n. 2). While the editor gives warning that "some corrections adopted in the text are omitted as too obvious or minor to be worth recording" (p. 9), I do not believe that this *caveat* can justify printing the conjecture *Palaestini* (J. Selden) in the text in 2.1.161, without alerting the reader in the *apparatus* to the fact that it is a conjecture (and without crediting Selden), when the reading of *M* is *palam est uidi*; or printing *populo* in 3.3.143, with no indication that the reading of *M* is *populos*; or printing *Trachinia* (3.5.57) with no indication that *M* has *intracia*.

Using "the information based mainly on Courtney's" (p. 9), the editor develops an extensive work of conjecture, *ope ingenii* (and not *ope codicum*). As an editor, he neither judged it necessary to consult the secondary bibliography, nor the great older editions of the *Silvae*, such as that of J. Markland (Londini 1728, Dresdae – Londini 1827²) or that of A. Klotz (Leipzig: Teubner, 1899, 1911³). Thus, the conjectures of Markland cited by Sh. B. seem to be derived, at second hand, from Courtney's edition. It would have proved quite useful also, and would have saved the editor from numerous mistakes (especially those concerning the attribution of conjectures), to have consulted the "Variorum" editions of Statius' works, such as the English edition of A. J. Valpy (London 1824) and the French of J. A. Amar – N. E. Lemaire (Paris 1825), as well as some extensive reviews recently published on the editions and commentaries of Statius: for example, those of R. Mayer and L. Håkanson on van Dam's commentary (1984), in *CR* 36, 1984, 50-1 and *Gnomon* 59, 1987, 62-4, respectively; of H. J. van Dam on Coleman's commentary (1988) in *Gnomon* 62, 1990, 745-7; and

of the present writer on Courtney's edition (1990) in *Gnomon* 66, 1994, 14-8.

It is appropriate to ask what is achieved in establishing the text in spite of this flagrant penury of documentation. The results are mixed. Sh. B. achieves undoubted successes, thanks to his soundness as a Latinist and his subtlety as a textual critic, but there are also a number of questionable proposals and obvious errors. In general terms, to say that Sh. B.'s text is not conservative is an understatement. He adopts hundreds of conjectures by previous scholars. He also includes in his text more than thirty conjectures of his own. The majority of Sh. B.'s conjectures are discussed in detail in the "Critical Appendix" (pp. 383-404), which collects material previously published by him. However, I have noticed that on at least four occasions the editor prints, as his own, conjectures previously proposed by other scholars: at 1.4.49, *cedit* (for *fidit* in *M*) was already proposed by Phillimore in his Oxford edition (1905); at 5.2.166, *properare* (*preferre* *M*) is Saenger's conjecture, included in his Russian edition (1909) (and appeared as such in the critical *apparatus* of the Teubner edition by Klotz); at 5.3.56-57, *en... ligarent* (*et...-em* *M*), *en* appears to be original, but *ligarent*, as well as *dicarent*, was already suggested by N. Heinsius in *Adversariorum libri IV*, Amstelodami 1742, 587, as Valpy reproduces very clearly in his edition (1824, p. 545); at 5.5.8, *tanti* (*-is* *M*) was anticipated by Traglia in his edition (1978).

I list, by way of example, some of the editor's undeniable achievements (and the list could easily be extended) 1. *Praef.* 30 *nam Claudii Etrusci testimonium donandum est* (*domonnum* *M*): the conjecture *donandum* restores the sense of this very corrupt passage, and demonstrates the editor's command of Latin, as he detects in the verb *donare* the unusual sense of "to waive" (*OLD s.u. dono* 4); 1.3.1 *Tibur<s> glaciale*, where the restoration *Tibur<s>* is necessary, with the sense of "an estate at Tibur" (*OLD s.u. Tiburs*), against the paradosis *Tibur*; 3.3.78 *ab aere* (*habere* *M*) gives an adequate sense and is highly plausible; 3.3.179-80 *haud aliter gemuit per Sunia* (Polster: *periuria* *M*) *Theseus / litora quem (qui* *M*) *deceperat Aegaea velis:*

the brilliant conjecture *quem* smoothes the syntax and clarifies the sense of the phrase, completing Polster's no less brilliant paleographic conjecture *per Sunia*.

Furthermore, it is to the editor's credit that he accepts certain conjectures from previous scholars: 1.2.9 *furata* (Sandstroem: *futura* M; *suffulta* Leo, Courtney); 1.2.12 *lumina demissa* (Itali: *lumine* M, oddly accepted by Courtney) is a stock phrase (see Verg. *Aen.* 1.156, Stat. *Theb.* 3.367, etc.); 1.2.155 *subibit* (van Dam: *subivit* M); 1.2.136 *in hanc ver<s>o cecidisset Iuppiter auro* (Herzog: *vero* is M's bland reading, accepted by Courtney); 2.1.113 *Graius* (Itali: *gratus* M; *Graius* was defended by van Dam in his edition, pp. 125-6, and by Håkanson, *Gnomon* 59, 1987, 64, although wrongly rejected by Courtney); 3.2.75 <g>*audebant* (Markland, Courtney; see L. Håkanson, *Statius' Silvae*, Lund 1969, 81-2); 3.4.66 *gaudia* (Gronovius, Courtney), where *gratia* (M) would imply that *fuscaret* should be taken as intransitive (the only instance in Latin, according to *ThlL* 6/1, 1653, 32 ff.); 4.1.9 *bis senus honos* (Saenger: *sextus* M, obelized by Courtney) is an adequate metonymy to designate the consulate, since in Statian style the expression is just a slight variation of *bis seni fasces*.

Other choices or conjectures seem less plausible or wholly inadequate to me. I begin with matters of punctuation: 3.1.49-50 *Sed quaenam subiti, veneranda, exordia templi / dic age, Calliope*. Sh. B. translates "revered Calliope", but it is preferable to take *veneranda* with *exordia* and to suppress the comma after *veneranda* (cf. 1.3.38-9 *venerabile dicam / lucorum senium?*); 3.5.105 *mille tibi nostrae referam telluris amores?*, the question mark, though traditional, should be removed. In the spelling of the name of Puteoli's mythical founder (possibly an invention of Statius himself), Sh. B. postulates a double spelling after Krohn and Courtney: *Dicaearchus* (genitive *Dicaearchi* at 3.1.92 and 3.5.75; dative *Dicaearcho* at 4.8.8) and *Dicarchus* (genitive *Dicharchi* as clausula of 2.2.96); I follow Marastoni and Coleman in thinking that a single spelling, *Dicarcheus*, is to be preferred in these four places: genitive *Dicharchei* (*Dicarchei* being scanned with synizesis in the ending of 2.2.96) and dative *Dicharcheo* (*M* reads *dicachen* here; the corruption *Dicharcheo*

> *dicachen* is easy to explain paleographically; see my *Estacio. Silvas III*, 159-60).

2.1.223-23 *non ille rogavit, / non timuit meruitve mori*, the conjecture *renuitve* (N. Heinsius, *Adversariorum libri IV*, Amstelodami 1742, 609, put forward by Markland as his own and accepted by Courtney) is highly preferable to M's *meruitve*. *renuit* is practically synonymous with *temuit* (note the disjunctive *-ve*, which emphasizes the equivalence), and why would Glaucias have deserved to die? Indeed, the emendation *renuit* was also defended by A. E. Housman, in the introduction to his *Manilius* (p. xlix); 3 *Praef.* 18 admittedly *scis* (Vollmer's conjecture, not cited, for M's *scit*) introduces an anacoluthon (of which there are several examples in Statius), but keeping *scit* makes more sense and avoids the anomalous value of *eius*; 3.1.151 *ridetque* (M) cannot have the meaning of "smiles... at", as previously indicated; I proposed in my edition the correction to *visitque*; 3.1.164 *nunc ipsum in limine cerno* (*ipsum* Calderni: *ipse* M): *ipse* is preferable, since the combination *ipse... cerno* emphasizes the miraculous privilege of witnessing a divine epiphany (as in Verg. *ecl.* 10.26 *Pan deus Arcadiae venit, quem vidimus ipsi* and *Aen.* 4.358-9); 3.1.175 *iuvenes* (M) does not make good sense; I proposed in my edition *iuvenis* (agreeing with the subject of the clause); 3.5.57-9 *non sic Trachinia nidos / Alcyone, vernos non sic Philomela penates / circumit*, the adjective *vernos* (a correction of the Itali, not indicated by Sh. B., for M's *nervos*), with *penates* (l. 58), contributes a trivial notion; it is preferable to correct *nervos* to *hibernos*, and to make *hibernos* agree with the *nidos* of l. 57, printing the comma after *vernos*; they are "halcyon nests" (see *Theb.* 9.362 *algentes... nidos*, *Ov. met.* 9.745-6); 3.5.104: It does not seem acceptable to me that the editor should invent a non-existent toponym *Venarumque* (*denarum* M); in my edition I opted for the earlier conjecture *Inarimesque*.

In summary, a modern and revitalized Statius in the prestigious and widely read Loeb collection, catering to a scholarly Anglophone audience, not necessarily specialized in Statius' *Silvae*, would have been highly desirable. The editor had the necessary talent, as both a Latinist and a textual critic.

The English translation is much more modern, readable, and idiomatic than that of Mozley. In the establishment of the Latin text quite a few successes are attained. Unfortunately, the neglect of scholarly documentation, both primary (manuscripts, editions, commentaries) and secondary (monographs, articles, reviews), the rash and systematic recourse to conjecture *ope ingenii*, the application of an erratic and inconsistent methodology, the hasty elaboration of the work, and the carelessness in the editorial revision make for a disappointing final product, and in short, a great opportunity lost².

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